

Wednesday, 5 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

24° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

20° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

19° 15°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

18° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **More than 170 migrants have been rescued after their boat caught fire in the Channel while attempting to cross to the UK.**

The government has confirmed that all those on board will be returned to France. This incident highlights the ongoing dangers of these crossings.

MIGRATION · UK

- 2 **Scottish students are celebrating today as exam pass rates have risen across the country.**

Over 148,000 learners received their results, with details of this year's pass rates now published. It's a day of relief and excitement for many.

EDUCATION · UK

- 3 **Good news for young people travelling by train, as half-price rail travel has been extended to 18-year-olds.**

They'll now be able to buy the 16-17 Saver railcard right up until the day before they turn 18. This should make travel more affordable for many.

TRANSPORT · UK

- 4 **A powerful new film by teenagers highlights the misogyny girls face at school, including the existence of 'rape lists'.**

The film describes their experiences ahead of significant changes to the curriculum. It's a stark reminder of the challenges some young people face.

SOCIAL ISSUES · UK

- 5 **Tragic news from London, where a 14-year-old boy has died after going into the water at Millwall Outer Dock.**

Emergency services recovered the teenager's body on Monday night. Our thoughts are with his family and friends.

TRAGEDY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Spider-Man fans are absolutely buzzing after seeing Tom Holland's latest web-slinging adventure, 'Brand New Day'.**
Many are hailing it as his best performance yet. It sounds like another blockbuster for the Marvel universe.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of the Spider-Man films? What makes Tom Holland's portrayal so popular?
FILM · COMING UP
- 2 Glasgow has a starring role in the new Spider-Man film, 'Brand New Day', doubling as New York City.**
It's always great to see British cities featuring in huge Hollywood productions. Keep an eye out for familiar streets!
ON AIR – Have you ever spotted your hometown or a familiar place in a big movie, pretending to be somewhere else?
FILM · COMING UP
- 3 British girl band FLO are making waves, confidently declaring they 'want it all' as they work on their second album.**
The rising stars say making 'Therapy at the Club' was a 'crash course' in music. They're definitely ones to watch.
ON AIR – Which new British music acts are you excited about right now? Who do you think will be the next big thing?
MUSIC · COMING UP
- 4 London is set to host the debut Mahrajan Festival, a 'milestone' for the Arabic community.**
The festival will feature performances from artists like Saint Levant and Dystinct. It sounds like a fantastic celebration of culture.
ON AIR – Are you planning to go to any festivals this summer? What kind of music or culture are you hoping to experience?
FESTIVAL · COMING UP
- 5 Love Island fans are increasingly choosing the US edition, saying 'they actually fancy each other' over there.**
Commentators and former Islanders are reflecting on what the dating series could do to draw in more UK viewers again. It seems the US version is hitting all the right notes.
ON AIR – Are you a Love Island fan, and if so, do you prefer the UK or US version? What do you think makes a good dating show?
TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Chelsea fans might see Mykhailo Mudryk back in action as early as Wednesday, after a 20-month drugs suspension.**

He's been named in Chelsea's squad to play Juventus in a friendly in Hong Kong. It'll be interesting to see him back on the pitch.

ON AIR – After such a long break, how do you think players manage to get back to their top form? Is it all about physical training, or is the mental game just as important?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Welsh Fire secured a dramatic victory over Southern Brave in a nail-biting finish, ending their winning streak.**

They chased down 122 runs with the final ball of the game, punishing the visitors' costly mistakes. What a finish!

ON AIR – Do you prefer the drama of a close game that goes down to the wire, or a dominant performance from your team? Which is more exciting to watch?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Coventry City have confirmed the permanent signing of goalkeeper Carl Rushworth from Brighton and Hove Albion.**

The 25-year-old had been on loan and will now join the club permanently. A good bit of business for Coventry.

ON AIR – How important is a good goalkeeper to a team's success? Do you think they're often overlooked compared to goal-scorers?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Teenage Cardiff hooker Tom Howe is being tipped as one to watch for Wales, but he's staying grounded.**

He's yet to make his debut for Cardiff, but the hype is building around this young talent. Definitely a name to remember.

ON AIR – When you hear about a young talent, what are you most excited to see from them? Is it their skill, their attitude, or something else?

RUGBY · UK

5 **The Women's Open has delivered some incredible shots, with Charley Hull, Lottie Woad, and Nelly Korda starring.**

You can catch the best moments from the 2026 edition. It sounds like it was a fantastic tournament.

ON AIR – What's your favourite shot in golf to watch? Is it a long drive, a tricky chip, or a perfect putt?

GOLF · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent trend sees more people embracing 'digital detox holidays', swapping screens for serene landscapes.**
Travellers are increasingly seeking destinations where Wi-Fi is limited or non-existent, preferring to reconnect with nature and conversation rather than their inboxes. It's all about switching off to truly switch on to relaxation.
- 2 The simple joy of 'baking bread from scratch' is experiencing a delightful resurgence across the country.**
From sourdough starters to simple loaves, more home cooks are discovering the therapeutic process and delicious rewards of kneading their own dough. There's nothing quite like the smell of fresh bread, is there?
- 3 Experts are suggesting that 'learning a few phrases in a new language', even casually, can boost cognitive function.**
Even just picking up some greetings or common phrases from a language you find interesting can give your brain a lovely workout. It's a fun way to keep your mind sharp and maybe even impress someone on holiday!
- 4 The surprising appeal of 'collecting vintage stamps' is captivating a new generation of hobbyists.**
Once seen as an older pursuit, young collectors are now drawn to the intricate designs, historical stories, and artistic value of stamps from different eras and countries. It's a little piece of history in your hand.
- 5 A new study highlights the 'comforting power of listening to rain' for relaxation and sleep.**
The gentle, consistent rhythm of rainfall is being recognised for its ability to calm the mind and create a peaceful atmosphere. Forget fancy apps, sometimes nature's own soundtrack is the best.
- 6 There's a growing appreciation for 'local community gardens', fostering connections and fresh produce.**
These shared green spaces are not just providing fresh fruits and vegetables, but also creating wonderful opportunities for neighbours to meet, share skills, and build a stronger community spirit. Green-fingered fun for everyone!
- 7 The simple act of 'observing cloud formations' is being celebrated as a mindful and imaginative pastime.**
Taking a moment to look up at the sky and find shapes or stories in the clouds can be a wonderfully relaxing way to unwind and let your imagination roam. It's free, it's calming, and it's always changing!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to choose a new book, even if we know we shouldn't judge it?

ANSWER: ...JUDGING IT BY ITS COVER, OF COURSE! YOU JUST CAN'T HELP IT, CAN YOU?

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to watch their favourite TV show. What is it?

ANSWER: ...MAKING SURE ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA ARE PERFECTLY PLUMPED AND ALIGNED! COMFORT IS KEY, AFTER ALL!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'unforgettable smells' that instantly transport us back to a specific memory, don't we?**
What's a particular scent that, when you smell it, immediately takes you back to a specific time or place in your life? Give us a call and share your aromatic recollections!

- **Think about those 'little everyday triumphs' that just make your day feel a bit more special.**
What's a small, perhaps overlooked, achievement or moment in your day that makes you feel quietly triumphant? Maybe finding a parking space, or perfectly peeling an orange? We'd love to hear your little wins!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins have a special gland that allows them to drink salty seawater and excrete the salt through their beaks.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 officially started in a baker's shop on Pudding Lane.
- The oldest known living tree in the world, named Methuselah, is a Bristlecone Pine over 4,800 years old.
- The world's smallest commercially produced car is the Peel P50, a three-wheeled microcar.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar.
- The average cloud weighs about 550 tons, which is roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- There are more than 10,000 different varieties of tomatoes worldwide.
- The sound of a human sneeze can travel at speeds of up to 100 miles per hour.
- The inventor of the traffic light was Garrett Morgan, an African American inventor, in 1923.

On this day

Day 217 of the year, 148 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abel of Reims; Christian feast day: Addai; Christian feast day: Afra; Christian feast day: Cassian of Autun. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Ryan Bertrand, English footballer
- 1961 — Tim Wilson, American comedian, singer-songwriter, and guitarist (died 2014)
- 1946 — Erika Slezak, American actress
- 1955 — Eddie Ojeda, American guitarist and songwriter
- 1945 — Loni Anderson, American actress (died 2025)
- 1967 — Matthew Caws, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1966 — Jennifer Finch, American singer, bass player, and photographer (died 2026)
- 1961 — Mark O'Connor, American violinist/fiddler and composer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1995 — Yugoslav Wars: The city of Knin, Croatia, a significant Serb stronghold, is taken by Croatian forces during Operation Storm. The date is celebrated in Croatia as Victory Day.
- 1974 — Watergate scandal: President Richard Nixon, under orders of the US Supreme Court, releases the "Smoking Gun" tape, recorded on June 23, 1972, clearly revealing his actions in covering up and interfering investigations into the break-in. His political support vanishes completely.
- 1965 — The Indo-Pakistani war of 1965 begins as Pakistani soldiers cross the Line of Control dressed as locals.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1957 — American Bandstand, a show dedicated to the teenage "baby-boomers" by playing the songs and showing popular dances of the time, debuts on the ABC television network.
- 1974 — Watergate scandal: President Richard Nixon, under orders of the US Supreme Court, releases the "Smoking Gun" tape, recorded on June 23, 1972, clearly revealing his actions in covering up and interfering investigations into the break-in. His political support vanishes completely.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1963 — Cold War: The United States, the United Kingdom, and the Soviet Union sign the Partial Nuclear Test Ban Treaty.

- 1949 — In Montana, 12 smokejumper firefighters and 1 US Forest Service fire guard are killed in the Mann Gulch Fire.
- 1971 — The first Pacific Islands Forum (then known as the "South Pacific Forum") is held in Wellington, New Zealand, with the aim of enhancing cooperation between the independent countries of the Pacific Ocean.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 218 of the year, 147 days left in 2026. Today Christian holidays and observances Transfiguration of Jesus; Christian holidays and observances Anna Maria Rubatto; Christian holidays and observances Pope Hormisdas; Christian holidays and observances Justus and Pastor. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — Joyce Sims, American singer (died 2022)
- 1942 — Byard Lancaster, American saxophonist and flute player (died 2012)
- 1961 — Mary Ann Sieghart, English journalist and radio host
- 1937 — Charlie Haden, American bassist and composer (died 2014)
- 1954 — Mark Hughes, English-Australian rugby league player
- 1928 — Andy Warhol, American painter, photographer and film director (died 1987)
- 1951 — Catherine Hicks, American actress
- 1938 — Paul Bartel, American actor, director, and screenwriter (died 2000)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1986 — A low-pressure system that redeveloped off the New South Wales coast dumps a record 328 millimeters (13 inches) of rain in a day on Sydney, New South Wales, Australia.
- 2012 — NASA's Curiosity rover lands on the surface of Mars.
- 2015 — A suicide bomb attack kills at least 15 people at a mosque in the Saudi city of Abha.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2011 — War in Afghanistan: A United States military helicopter is shot down, killing 30 American special forces members and a working dog, seven Afghan soldiers, and one Afghan civilian. It was the deadliest single event for the United States in the War in Afghanistan.
- 1956 — After going bankrupt in 1955, the American broadcaster DuMont Television Network makes its final broadcast, a boxing match from St. Nicholas Arena in New York in the Boxing from St. Nicholas Arena series.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)